



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Half-Yearly Exam — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Who prepares the Economic Survey of India? (A) The Reserve Bank of India (B) The Planning Commission (C) The Parliament directly (D) The Ministry of Finance Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Economic Survey of India is an important annual document prepared by the Ministry of Finance and presented in Parliament before the Union Budget. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1
2	What is the primary focus of Social Science as a field of study? (A) The systematic study of human society and the intricate patterns of human interactions (B) The systematic study of the natural world and physical phenomena (C) The study of only past events and historical timelines (D) The study of only economic activities and resource distribution Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Social Science is the systematic study of human society, which explains why events occur, how people live together, and how different aspects of life are interconnected. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	The chapter states that Indian political thought adopted a holistic approach linking politics with multiple domains. Which of the following correctly lists these domains? (A) Geography, history, literature, and art (B) Economics, social life, morality, and defence (C) Physics, chemistry, biology, and mathematics (D) Numismatics, epigraphy, archaeology, and genealogy Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Indian political thought adopted a holistic approach, linking politics with economics, social life, morality, and defence, viewing power as a responsibility rather than merely a privilege. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1
4	What is the key difference between weathering and erosion? (A) Weathering involves movement of material; erosion does not (B) Both involve movement of material (C) Neither involves movement of material (D) Erosion involves movement of material; weathering does not Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Weathering only breaks down rocks without movement, while erosion involves the wearing away and carrying of material from one place to another. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
5	In which year did the Akkadian city-state emerge, overshadowing Sumerian power? (A) 3000 BCE (B) 2334 BCE (C) 2500 BCE (D) 2154 BCE Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. In 2334 BCE, the power of the Sumerians was overshadowed by the emergence of a new city-state centred on the city of Akkad in central Mesopotamia. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
6	Which type of democracy is practised in Switzerland? (A) Presidential Democracy (B) Representative Democracy (C) Parliamentary Democracy (D) Direct Democracy Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Direct Democracy — Switzerland practises Direct Democracy, where executive power lies with the Federal Council and the President is the Head of the Government.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	
7	India's multi-party system is said to reflect which of the following? (A) The country's rich diversity of languages, cultures, religions, and regions (B) The country's federal structure and separation of powers (C) The country's colonial history and administrative divisions (D) The country's economic policies and development priorities Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. India has a multi-party system where many political parties exist and compete in elections, reflecting the country's rich diversity of languages, cultures, religions, and regions. <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	1
8	During which period did humans begin using microlithic tools and occupying temporary settlements near rivers and lakes? (A) Mesolithic period (B) Palaeolithic period (C) Neolithic period (D) Chalcolithic period Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Mesolithic period — because in the Mesolithic period, humans developed microlithic tools and began occupying temporary settlements near rivers and lakes. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1
9	The Arthaśhāstra examined which of the following subjects, demonstrating that systematic thinking about governance and the economy existed long before modern academic disciplines developed? (A) The five great elements and their influence on human settlement patterns (B) The interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures (C) Administration, economic management, taxation, and the duties of rulers toward their people (D) The evolution of villages into towns and towns into cities Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The Arthaśhāstra examined administration, economic management, taxation, and the duties of rulers toward their people, showing systematic thinking about governance and the economy existed in India long before modern academic disciplines. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
10	What is the purpose of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted by the ECI? (A) To conduct exit polls after elections (B) To allocate election symbols to political parties (C) To update, verify, and correct the electoral rolls ensuring no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included (D) To decide the schedule and dates for elections Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) involves updating, verifying, and correcting the electoral rolls. Through SIR, the ECI ensures that no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included in the electoral roll. [Ch 7: Elections]	1
11	Parabolic dunes differ from barchan dunes in which of the following ways? (A) Parabolic dunes are crescent-shaped; barchan dunes are U-shaped (B) Parabolic dunes have multiple arms; barchan dunes are long ridges parallel to wind (C) Parabolic dunes are U-shaped and often stabilised by vegetation; barchan dunes are crescent-shaped (D) Parabolic dunes form with multiple wind directions; barchan dunes form with a single wind direction Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Parabolic dunes are U-shaped and often stabilised by vegetation, while barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
12	Which of the following pairs represents complementary goods? (A) Cars and petrol (B) Tea and coffee (C) Mangoes and bananas (D) Oranges and mangoes Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Cars and petrol are complementary goods because they are generally used together to provide utility to the consumer. [Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]	1
13	Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a way Aśhoka's edicts promoted dhamma? (A) Strict enforcement of varṇa rules (B) Moral conduct (C) Respect within the family (D) Non-violence and compassion	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Aśhoka's edicts promoted dhamma by emphasising moral conduct, respect within the family, ethical behaviour in everyday life, non-violence, and compassion. Strict enforcement of varṇa rules is not mentioned. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
14	What is the average height of the troposphere? (A) About 50 kilometres (B) About 5 kilometres (C) About 12 kilometres (D) About 100 kilometres Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. About 12 kilometres — The troposphere has an average height of about 12 kilometres and is the most important layer of the atmosphere. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	1
15	A garment manufacturer finds that machines are expensive and labour is cheap and easily available. Which production method is the firm most likely to prefer? (A) Capital-intensive production using more machines (B) Labour-intensive production using more workers (C) A complete shutdown of production until machines become affordable (D) Outsourcing all production to another country Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. If machines are expensive, the firm will rely more on labour. If labour is cheap and easily available, labour-intensive methods are preferred. The choice depends on the cost of capital, availability of factors, and the nature of the product. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1
16	Which type of weathering occurs when minerals in rocks change due to reactions with water, air, or acids? (A) Physical weathering (B) Biological weathering (C) Mechanical weathering (D) Chemical weathering Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Chemical weathering occurs when minerals in rocks change because of reactions with water, air, or acids, leading to new substances. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
17	In the neighbourhood park example, why might the park never get built even though everyone needs it? (A) Because private companies would build it more efficiently (B) Because the government does not allow public parks in residential areas (C) Because many families think others will pay and they can use it without paying (D) Because the cost of land is too high for any single family Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Because many families think others will pay and they can use it without paying, which leads to not enough money being collected and the park never being built, even though everyone needs it. <i>[Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]</i>	1
18	The word 'dharma' is derived from which Sanskrit root? (A) Dhri (B) Sat (C) Rit (D) Sam Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The word 'dharma' is derived from the Sanskrit root dhri, which is also the root of dharati (the earth). <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	1
19	Which Article of the Indian Constitution provides for amendments to ensure it remains flexible and responsive? (A) Article 32 (B) Article 14 (C) Article 19 (D) Article 368 Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Constitution provides for amendments under Article 368, which ensures that the Constitution remains flexible and responsive to changing socio-political needs. <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1
20	Under the National Monsoon Mission (NMM), which ministry developed state-of-the-art weather and climate prediction models? (A) Ministry of Agriculture (B) Ministry of Environment and Forests (C) Ministry of Science and Technology (D) Ministry of Earth Sciences Answer: Correct Option: (D)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? D. Ministry of Earth Sciences — The Ministry of Earth Sciences (Government of India) developed state-of-the-art weather and climate prediction models under the NMM to enhance monsoon predictions over all time frames. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	How do political parties help ensure that democracy functions effectively? Mention any two ways. Answer: Political parties help ensure that democracy functions effectively by providing governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement. They also present diverse viewpoints in terms of programmes and policies, thus helping voters make informed choices. ► Why? The answer draws from multiple parts of the source to explain the role of political parties in sustaining democracy. [Ch 7: Elections]	2
	OR Describe any three key characteristics of the troposphere. Answer: The troposphere has an average height of about 12 kilometres. Temperature decreases with increasing altitude in this layer. Nearly all weather phenomena such as rainfall, fog, and hail occur here, and it contains the air we breathe along with most of the water vapour and clouds. ► Why? The question requires the student to recall multiple characteristics of the troposphere from the source, testing comprehension rather than simple identification. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
22	What was the Egyptian belief regarding 'ka' and how did it lead to the construction of pyramids? Answer: Egyptians believed that each person had a ka, a spiritual double, that lived on after death if the body was preserved through mummification. This belief led to the burial of pharaohs underground with mastabas placed over them, which were eventually stacked to form pyramids. ► Why? This question tests the connection between Egyptian religious beliefs about the afterlife and the architectural evolution of pyramids. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	2
	OR Distinguish between stalactites and stalagmites based on their formation and position in caves.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Stalactites are icicle-shaped formations hanging from the ceiling of caves, while stalagmites are formations rising from the floor of caves. Both are landforms of underground water created through chemical weathering and erosion in areas of limestone or soluble rocks, known as Karst topography. ► Why? The question tests the ability to differentiate between two similar Karst landforms based on their position and formation. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
23	Which Buddhist text describes the eight stages of agricultural operations, and what does this indicate about farming practices in the post-Mauryan period? Answer: The Milindapaṇḥo, a Buddhist text traditionally attributed to Nāgasena, describes eight stages of agricultural operations ranging from preparing and weeding fields to harvesting and winnowing crops. This indicates a detailed understanding of farming practices during the post-Mauryan period. ► Why? The question tests knowledge of a specific textual source and its significance for understanding agricultural development in the post-Mauryan era. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	2
24	What is the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and what role does it play in preserving cultural memory? Answer: The itihāsa-purāṇa tradition is one of the oldest and most influential traditions of preserving cultural memory in Bharat. Through stories, it shares historical information and gives cultural meaning to events and people, reinforcing enduring ideals and values and offering a sense of identity and purpose. ► Why? The source describes this tradition as a storytelling method that conveys both historical information and cultural meaning, reinforcing values and identity. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	2
25	Why is media referred to as the 'fourth pillar of democracy'? Answer: Media is referred to as the 'fourth pillar of democracy' owing to its critical role in safeguarding people's voices and upholding democratic principles. Newspapers, news channels, and social media platforms raise issues concerning the public and contribute to their resolution through appropriate mechanisms. ► Why? This tests understanding of the role media plays in a democratic setup and the reason behind its designation as the fourth pillar. [Ch 6: Democracy]	2
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	How are waterfalls formed, and what significance do they hold for human activities?	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: A waterfall forms in the upper course of rivers, where hard rocks resist erosion while softer rocks below are worn away, creating a sudden vertical drop. Waterfalls are significant for humans in several ways. They attract tourists, making them important for local tourism and economy. The force of falling water can be harnessed for hydroelectric power generation. They also provide opportunities for recreation such as trekking and photography. Additionally, waterfalls often hold cultural or religious significance in certain regions, making them valuable beyond their natural beauty. ► Why? The answer combines the geological process of waterfall formation with their multiple human significances, requiring students to connect physical geography with human activity. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Explain how waterfalls form in the upper course through differential erosion of hard and soft rocks. 2. Step 2: Describe the tourism and economic significance of waterfalls. 3. Step 3: Mention hydroelectric power, recreation, and cultural/religious significance. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
	OR Describe the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and its significance in preserving cultural memory in Bharat. Answer: The itihāsa-purāṇa tradition is one of the oldest and most influential traditions of preserving cultural memory in Bharat. Through stories, this tradition not only shares historical information but also gives cultural meaning to events and people. In doing so, it reinforces enduring ideals and values, offering a sense of identity and purpose. This tradition represents one of the multiple ways to interpret the past and transmit cultural values from one generation to the next, showing that history is not merely about facts but also about meaning and continuity. ► Why? The answer explains how the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition preserves cultural memory through stories that convey both information and meaning. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition as an ancient tradition of preserving cultural memory 2. Step 2: Explain how it shares historical information and cultural meaning through stories 3. Step 3: Conclude with how it reinforces ideals, values, identity, and purpose [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
27	What was the Code of Hammurabi, and why was it significant for future legal systems?	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The Code of Hammurabi was a compilation of rules and regulations for civil and social conduct promulgated by Hammurabi, who ascended in 1792 BCE and expanded Babylonia into a large empire. The code was inscribed on a stone stele showing King Hammurabi receiving the law from Shamash, the Babylonian god of justice, with the law codes inscribed in cuneiform below the relief. Its most significant contribution was that it served as a foundational model for many future legal systems. By codifying civil and social rules across his empire, Hammurabi established a standardised framework of governance that influenced subsequent legal traditions and provided a structured approach to justice. ► Why? The answer describes the Code of Hammurabi as a compilation of civil and social rules, its divine presentation, and its role as a model for future legal systems. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define the Code of Hammurabi as compiled rules for civil and social conduct 2. Step 2: Mention Hammurabi's ascendance in 1792 BCE and the stele depicting Shamash, the god of justice 3. Step 3: Explain its significance as a foundational model for future legal systems [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
	OR What is participatory democracy, and how does it differ from merely holding periodic elections? Answer: Participatory democracy emphasises greater involvement of citizens not only through elections but also through active engagement in shaping policies and governance. While periodic elections enable people to choose their representatives, participatory democracy goes beyond this by involving citizens in decision-making through mechanisms such as local councils, public consultations, and community-driven initiatives. The conduct of periodic elections is one of the most widely recognised features of a democratic system, but a deeper understanding of democracy requires appreciation of citizens' broader role. Thus, participatory democracy ensures that citizens remain engaged in governance between elections, making democracy more responsive and inclusive at all levels. ► Why? The answer distinguishes participatory democracy from electoral democracy by emphasizing continuous citizen engagement beyond voting. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define participatory democracy 2. Step 2: Contrast it with merely holding periodic elections 3. Step 3: Mention the mechanisms through which citizen participation takes place [Ch 6: Democracy]	
28	Why are periodic elections considered a crucial element of democracy? Explain with reference to accountability of elected representatives.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Periodic elections are essential because they ensure that elected representatives remain accountable to the people. The right to elect representatives and hold them accountable is ensured through regular elections, and our vote is the principal means by which we exercise this right. Without fresh elections, a representative like a class representative or a government could continue beyond the prescribed term without seeking the people's mandate again, which undermines democracy. If only one political party contests, citizens cannot exercise real choice. Thus, participating in periodic elections to choose those who make decisions on our behalf is one of the most crucial elements of democracy, ensuring that power remains with the people. ► Why? The answer connects periodic elections to accountability and popular mandate, using the chapter's reasoning about why elections cannot be skipped. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: State that periodic elections ensure accountability of elected representatives to the people 2. Step 2: Explain that the vote is the principal means of exercising this right and that terms cannot be extended without fresh elections 3. Step 3: Conclude that periodic elections keep democratic power with the people [Ch 7: Elections]	
29	Compare and contrast the land breeze and the sea breeze, explaining the mechanisms behind each. Answer: The sea breeze is a local wind that blows from sea to land during the day, especially in the afternoon, when the land becomes relatively warmer than the sea. This creates a low-pressure region over land, causing wind to blow from the sea. The land breeze blows from land to sea during the night, resulting from differential surface cooling — land cools faster than sea at night. Since the difference in temperatures and air pressure between sea and land is low at night, the wind speed is low. Both breezes are essential in creating moderate climatic conditions in coastal regions. The key difference lies in the time of occurrence and the direction of wind flow. ► Why? The answer contrasts sea breeze (daytime, sea to land) with land breeze (nighttime, land to sea) and explains the differential heating and cooling mechanisms behind each. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Describe the sea breeze — blows from sea to land during the day due to land warming faster. 2. Step 2: Describe the land breeze — blows from land to sea at night due to land cooling faster. 3. Step 3: Compare the two — note differences in timing, direction, and wind speed, and mention their role in coastal climate. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	3
30	What does the Rig Veda verse (9.112.3) reveal about occupational diversity in early Vedic society, and how does it challenge the idea of fixed hereditary occupations?	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The Rig Veda verse (9.112.3) describes a family where the seer is a poet, the father is a physician, and the mother is a grinder of corn. This verse reveals that multiple occupations existed within a single family, indicating that occupations in early Vedic society were flexible and mobile. It directly challenges the idea that social status and occupation were fixed by birth, since members of the same family pursued different professions. This evidence supports the view that the idea of strict hereditary occupations had not yet become firmly established, and that social identity was shaped by complex factors including occupation rather than birth alone. ► Why? The answer uses the specific verse to demonstrate occupational flexibility within families, contradicting the notion of birth-based fixed occupations in early Vedic society. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the three occupations mentioned in the verse within one family. 2. Step 2: Explain what this indicates about occupational flexibility in early Vedic society. 3. Step 3: Conclude by showing how this challenges the idea of fixed hereditary occupations. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Democracy does not offer a single model of government, and different societies institutionalise democracy in diverse ways. Compare and contrast the different types of democracy and systems of government, explaining how they are practised in India, Canada, the United Kingdom, and the United States of America.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Democracy does not offer a single model of government. While fundamental principles like freedom, equality, participation, rule of law, rights, and duties remain common, the characteristics and features of democracy vary from country to country. Different societies institutionalise democracy in diverse ways, depending on how citizens participate in decision-making and how political power is structured. Democracy is broadly classified into two types: Direct Democracy and Representative (Indirect) Democracy. In a Direct Democracy, citizens directly participate in most decision-making processes. However, it is difficult to follow in large countries, and Switzerland is an example. In a Representative Democracy, people elect their representatives and do not directly govern. It features periodic elections, and the government is accountable to the people. India is an example of this type. Representative Democracy is further divided into Parliamentary Democracy and Presidential Democracy. In a Parliamentary Democracy, members of the executive are also part of the legislature, and the executive is accountable to the legislature. People elect the legislature but not the executive. India and Canada follow this system. In a Presidential Democracy, the executive is independent of the legislature, the president is elected by the people, and the president is accountable to the people. The United States of America follows this system. India practises Representative Democracy in the form of Parliamentary Democracy, where executive power lies with the council of ministers headed by the Prime Minister. The President is the Head of State and the Prime Minister is the Head of Government. Key features include a multi-party democracy, a written constitution, Fundamental Rights and Duties, and federalism. Canada also follows a Parliamentary Democracy with executive power lying with the Prime Minister, featuring federalism and a multi-party system, though its Head of State is a Governor-General appointed by the Crown of the UK. The United Kingdom follows a Parliamentary Democracy with a Constitutional Monarchy, where executive power lies with the Prime Minister, the Monarch is the Head of State, and it has an unwritten constitution, parliamentary sovereignty, and a multi-party system. ► Why? <i>Democracy takes different forms across countries based on how citizens participate and how political power is structured, with key distinctions between direct and representative systems, and between parliamentary and presidential systems.</i> ► Step-by-step: <i>Step 1: Introduce the idea that democracy does not offer a single model and that fundamental principles remain common across democracies.</i> <i>Step 2: Explain the two broad types of democracy — Direct Democracy and Representative Democracy — with their features and examples.</i> <i>Step 3: Distinguish between Parliamentary Democracy and Presidential Democracy, explaining how executive accountability differs in each.</i> <i>Step 4: Compare the specific democratic systems practised in India, Canada, the United Kingdom, and the United States of America, highlighting their key features.</i> <i>Step 5: Conclude by noting that systems differ in how power is shared, who participates in decision-making, and whether checks and balances are in place.</i>	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 6: Democracy]	
	OR Describe the composition of the atmosphere and explain how the atmosphere regulates conditions on Earth, influencing weather and climate. Support your answer with relevant examples from the elements of weather discussed. Answer: The Earth's atmosphere is a blanket of air surrounding the Earth, pulled down by gravity. It is composed of a mixture of various gases. Nitrogen and oxygen are the two primary and most abundant gases, essential to life on Earth. Other gases present in lesser quantities include carbon dioxide, argon, helium, neon, krypton, xenon, ozone, and hydrogen. Besides gases, the atmosphere also contains water vapour, generally ranging from 0.1 per cent to 0.4 per cent, and tiny dust particles. Water vapour plays a significant role in cloud formation and precipitation. The composition of the atmosphere also varies with altitude. The atmosphere shields us from harmful radiation coming from the Sun, including ultraviolet radiation. It regulates the Earth's temperature by trapping some of the Sun's energy and preventing it from escaping back into space. It is a key component of the Earth's weather and climate systems, influencing factors such as temperature, humidity, and air pressure. Temperature varies between day and night and across seasons. An important factor affecting temperature distribution is insolation, which decreases from the equator towards the poles, causing temperature to decrease in the same direction. Humidity refers to the presence of water vapour in the air. As air gets warmer, its capacity to hold water vapour increases, leading to higher humidity. Precipitation occurs when the atmosphere becomes saturated with water vapour, which condenses and falls due to gravity in forms such as drizzle, rain, snow, sleet, and hail. Rain is the most common form and lowers the temperature of a place. Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface; it is highest at sea level and decreases with altitude. In areas with high temperatures, air heats up and rises, creating low pressure associated with cloudy skies and wet weather. In areas with lower temperatures, cold air sinks, creating high pressure associated with clear and sunny skies. Wind, the movement of air from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, further shapes weather conditions.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The atmosphere's gas composition and its role in regulating temperature, radiation, and weather elements such as humidity, precipitation, and pressure are all interconnected systems that sustain life and shape climate. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the atmosphere as a blanket of air pulled down by gravity and describe its gas composition including nitrogen, oxygen, and other trace gases, water vapour, and dust particles. 2. Step 2: Explain how the atmosphere shields Earth from harmful radiation and regulates temperature by trapping the Sun's energy. 3. Step 3: Discuss the elements of weather — temperature (insolation), humidity, precipitation, and atmospheric pressure — and how each is influenced by the atmosphere. 4. Step 4: Explain the relationship between temperature, pressure, and wind, including how high and low pressure areas form and their associated weather. 5. Step 5: Conclude by summarising how all these elements together constitute the Earth's weather and climate systems. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
32	Discuss how the River Nile shaped the growth of Egyptian civilisation, and explain how the Egyptians' understanding of their environment influenced their calendar, governance, and religious practices including mummification and pyramid construction. Answer: The River Nile played a central role in the growth of Egyptian civilisation. Egypt saw the emergence of city-states around 3000 BCE as population increased and resources became available. The Nile watered the land along its banks, and every summer the river flooded, leading to annual inundations that deposited rich mud called 'kemet', which was excellent for growing crops. Egyptians referred to their land as Kemet, meaning 'the black', coming from the black river valley soil. About 5000 years ago, farmers discovered that by digging ditches they could divert water from the Nile into their fields and store water in reservoirs for later use. By counting the days between Nile floods, the Egyptians developed a calendar with three seasons — Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and Shemu harvest (summer) — based on the rising of Sirius (Dog Star), with a year of 365 days (12 months × 30 days + 5 extra days). The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort, which led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, probably the earliest form of local government in Egypt. Over time, powerful individuals called Pharaohs emerged as rulers. Egyptians believed that each person had a ka (a spiritual double) that lived on after death if the body was preserved through mummification. Mummification involved removing the internal organs (except the heart), drying the body with natron, oiling it, wrapping it in linen strips, placing it in a coffin, and burying it with rituals. After death, pharaohs were buried deep underground with a rectangular structure called a mastaba placed over the burial chamber. Gradually, these mastabas were placed one on top of the other to form a pyramid, such as the step pyramid at Saqqara. Thus, the Nile's floods, the need for cooperation, and religious beliefs together shaped Egyptian civilisation.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The Nile's annual flooding created fertile land and necessitated cooperative irrigation efforts, which in turn gave rise to governance, calendar systems, and religious practices centered on the afterlife. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce how the Nile supported Egyptian civilisation — city-states around 3000 BCE, annual flooding, and 'kemet' soil. 2. Step 2: Explain the development of the calendar based on Nile flood cycles and the rising of Sirius, with three seasons and 365 days. 3. Step 3: Describe how collective irrigation efforts led to local government and the rise of the administrative class and Pharaohs. 4. Step 4: Explain religious beliefs — the ka, mummification process, and pyramid construction from mastabas, citing the step pyramid at Saqqara. 5. Step 5: Conclude by connecting the Nile's influence across agriculture, governance, calendar, and religion. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
	OR Weathering and erosion are continuous processes that reshape the Earth's surface. Explain the different types of weathering and erosion, and analyze how erosion impacts various human occupations and livelihoods. Answer: Weathering is the process through which rocks on the Earth's surface break down into smaller pieces without involving movement of the broken material. There are three main types of weathering. Physical weathering occurs when rocks break into smaller pieces due to temperature changes, frost, or wind. Chemical weathering happens when minerals in rocks change because of reactions with water, air, or acids, leading to new substances. Biological weathering is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms, for example, when plant roots grow into cracks of rocks and split them apart. Weathering plays an important role in shaping the Earth's surface and forming soil. Erosion is the process by which soil, rocks, and other surface materials are worn away and carried from one place to another by natural agents like water, wind, ice, or waves. Unlike weathering, erosion involves movement of the broken material. Types of erosion include water erosion caused by rivers, rain, or ocean waves; wind erosion common in dry and sandy areas; glacial erosion where moving ice scrapes and carries rocks; and coastal erosion where sea waves wear away land along the shore. Erosion significantly affects human occupations. For farmers, erosion removes the fertile topsoil needed for crop growth, leading to lower yields. For those living near rivers and coasts, erosion can wash away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property. In construction and mining, erosion destabilises land, posing safety risks. Even industries like tourism and fishing suffer, since beaches, rivers, and fertile lands may be destroyed. Historical Indian practices like the Zabo system in Nagaland used earthen bunds and check dams to reduce water velocity, prevent soil erosion, and allow sediment deposition, showing how communities actively responded to erosion challenges.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The question integrates the concepts of weathering types, erosion types, and their direct consequences on human livelihoods, requiring students to connect natural processes with socio-economic impacts. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define weathering and explain its three types — physical, chemical, and biological — with examples from the source. 2. Step 2: Define erosion and distinguish it from weathering by highlighting the movement of material. 3. Step 3: Describe the four types of erosion — water, wind, glacial, and coastal — with their causes. 4. Step 4: Analyze how erosion impacts farmers, coastal dwellers, construction workers, and tourism/fishing industries. 5. Step 5: Conclude by mentioning historical responses to erosion, such as the Zabo system in Nagaland. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
33	Why should we study Social Science? Discuss how it helps us understand the systems around us, appreciate diversity, participate in democratic life, and connect the past, present, and future. Answer: Social Science is essential because it helps us understand the systems created and managed by society—such as the houses we live in, the water we use, the roads we travel on, the schools we attend, the markets we visit, and even the digital spaces we use. It explains how these systems developed, how they function, and how they affect different groups of people. We live among people who speak different languages, follow diverse customs, and practise varied occupations. Social Science explains these variations as outcomes of geographical, historical, cultural, and economic factors. This understanding builds respect and cooperation among communities. It also helps us recognise how Indian culture binds this diversity together through an underlying unity, fostering a sense of belonging and shared identity. In a democratic society, citizens play an active role in public life. Laws, rights, and responsibilities guide how people live together. Understanding how governments function and how decisions are made prepares us to participate responsibly in civic life. Social Science strengthens our ability to think about shared challenges such as environmental protection, public health, employment, or urban growth. We learn to ask informed questions about their causes, effects, and possible solutions. This habit of careful questioning and reasoning is essential for addressing problems that affect society as a whole. Most importantly, Social Science connects the past, present, and future. By understanding how past decisions shaped the present, we become better equipped to make wiser choices for the future. It helps us see society as one connected story rather than a collection of separate pieces, preparing us to take part in shaping the world as informed and thoughtful citizens.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer integrates the multiple purposes of studying Social Science as outlined in the source: understanding societal systems, appreciating diversity, enabling democratic participation, and linking past, present, and future. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the importance of Social Science in understanding everyday systems like housing, water, roads, schools, markets, and digital spaces. 2. Step 2: Explain how Social Science accounts for diversity in languages, customs, and occupations through geographical, historical, cultural, and economic factors, and how it fosters unity and shared identity. 3. Step 3: Discuss the role of Social Science in democratic participation—understanding government functioning, laws, rights, responsibilities, and asking informed questions about shared challenges. 4. Step 4: Highlight how Social Science connects past, present, and future, enabling wiser choices for the future. 5. Step 5: Conclude by emphasising that Social Science helps us see society as one connected story and prepares us to be informed, thoughtful citizens. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
34	Trace the evolution of political organisation in the Indian subcontinent from the early Vedic period to the rise of mahājanapadas. How did the transition from kinship-based identity to territorial identity shape administrative systems?	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Early Vedic society was organised into janas, or clans—groups of people bound by kinship ties. The Rig Veda alone mentions about thirty janas, five of which (the Yadu, Turvaśha, Puru, Anu, and Druhyu) were collectively known as the pañchajana. During this period, the rājā functioned primarily as a clan chief who led the group in warfare and ensured the protection of its members. The name 'Bharata' first appears in the Rig Veda in reference to the 'Bharata jana', the people ruled by the family of the Bharatas, showing how early communities identified themselves through kinship. With the passage of time, the political organisation of Vedic society evolved into territorial entities known as janapadas. The term janapada literally means 'where a people (jana) first set its feet', indicating a transition from kinship-based identity to territorial identity. This transition happened between approximately 1000 BCE and 600 BCE. People were now connected not only by kinship ties but also by a sense of belonging to a land, giving them a more concrete sense of identity. This consolidation meant that control over land, agricultural production, and trade routes became increasingly important, leading to the development of more complex administrative systems. As a result, the period from approximately 600 BCE to 300 CE witnessed the rise of new political formations called mahājanapadas—bigger political units than janapadas. Historical sources usually speak of sixteen mahājanapadas. Among these, Magadha, located in present-day Bihar, gradually emerged as the most powerful due to its strategic location, fertile plains, and strong rulers. This expansion eventually led to the rise of the Mauryan Empire. The political landscape also evolved to include monarchical states (rājyas) and republican states (gaṇas or samghas). Meanwhile, in the Ganga plains, archaeological evidence shows increasing use of iron implements, a wider variety of grain, PGW pottery, and the refined NBPW with its smooth, glossy black surface, marking the emergence of a richer, more advanced material culture. ► Why? The answer traces the political evolution from kin-based clans (janas) to territorial units (janapadas) and then to larger political formations (mahājanapadas), highlighting how the shift from kinship to territorial identity drove the development of more complex administrative systems. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce early Vedic society as organised into kin-based clans (janas), mentioning the pañchajana and the role of the rājā as clan chief. 2. Step 2: Explain the transition to janapadas around 1000–600 BCE, defining the term and describing the shift from kinship-based to territorial identity. 3. Step 3: Discuss how control over land, agriculture, and trade routes led to more complex administrative systems. 4. Step 4: Describe the rise of mahājanapadas (approximately 600 BCE–300 CE), the sixteen mahājanapadas, and Magadha's emergence as the most powerful. 5. Step 5: Conclude with the archaeological evidence (iron implements, PGW, NBPW) and the emergence of monarchical and republican states. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
Section E Attempt 3 out of 4.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
35	Case Study: Wind Erosion and Desert Landforms In arid regions, strong winds pick up and carry away loose particles of sand and soil, gradually shaping the landscape through wind erosion. This process creates several distinctive landforms. Yardangs are streamlined rock ridges carved by wind, while ventifacts are rocks polished and shaped by sandblasting. Deflation hollows or blowouts are shallow depressions formed where loose material is removed, and desert pavements are flat surfaces left behind after finer particles are blown away. Dunes are hills or ridges of sand formed by wind in desert areas or along sandy coasts. Barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction, while star dunes have multiple arms and form where winds come from different directions. (i) What are yardangs and how are they formed? (ii) Distinguish between deflation hollows and desert pavements. (iii) Compare barchan dunes and star dunes in terms of their shape and the wind conditions under which they form. (iv) How do dunes serve as natural barriers for humans in coastal regions? Answer: (i) Yardangs are streamlined rock ridges carved by wind. (ii) Deflation hollows or blowouts are shallow depressions formed where loose material is removed by wind. Desert pavements are flat surfaces left behind after finer particles are blown away by wind. (iii) Barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction. Star dunes have multiple arms and form where winds come from different directions. (iv) Dunes act as natural barriers against desertification and wind erosion. In some coastal regions, they protect settlements from strong sea winds and waves. ► Why? i) Yardangs are streamlined rock ridges carved by wind. ii) Deflation hollows or blowouts are shallow depressions formed where loose material is removed by wind. Desert pavements are flat surfaces left behind after finer particles are blown away by wind. iii) Barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction. Star dunes have multiple arms and form where winds come from different directions. iv) Dunes act as natural barriers against desertification and wind erosion. In some coastal regions, they protect settlements from strong sea winds and waves. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? Answer: (i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. (ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. (iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. (iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning. ► Why? i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
36	Case Study: Early Human Ancestors and Stone Tools Around 3.3 million years ago, one of our earliest ancestors made the first stone tools, marking the beginning of 'human behaviour'. These ancestors came to be known as 'hominins' or tool makers. The tools they created functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. Homo habilis, the 'handy man', lived in Africa around 2-6 million years ago and made chopper stone tools. Their successors, Homo erectus, invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa, spreading into Europe and Asia. While all human ancestors were tool makers, it was Homo sapiens who developed complex technologies, including the bow and arrow, microblade tools, and symbolic communication through cave paintings and beads. (i) Why are early humans referred to as 'hominins'? (ii) What is meant by the term 'extra-corporal limbs' in the context of stone tools? (iii) Compare the contributions of Homo habilis and Homo erectus to early human technology. How did Homo sapiens further advance upon these developments? (iv) Why is the making of stone tools considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' rather than animal behaviour? Answer: (i) Early humans are referred to as 'hominins' or tool makers because they made the earliest stone tools, which marked the beginning of 'human behaviour' as opposed to animal behaviour, since animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. (ii) Stone tools are called 'extra-corporal limbs' because they functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. (iii) Homo habilis made chopper stone tools and lived in Africa 2-6 million years ago. Homo erectus invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa. While all ancestors were tool makers, Homo sapiens developed complex technologies including the bow and arrow, parallel-sided blade and microblade tools, symbolic communication, cave paintings, and beads of stone, bone, and shell. (iv) The making of stone tools is considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' because animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. This cognitive ability to create and use tools distinguished early humans from animals.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? i) Early humans are referred to as 'hominins' or tool makers because they made the earliest stone tools, which marked the beginning of 'human behaviour' as opposed to animal behaviour, since animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. ii) Stone tools are called 'extra-corporal limbs' because they functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. iii) Homo habilis made chopper stone tools and lived in Africa 2-6 million years ago. Homo erectus invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa. While all ancestors were tool makers, Homo sapiens developed complex technologies including the bow and arrow, parallel-sided blade and microblade tools, symbolic communication, cave paintings, and beads of stone, bone, and shell. iv) The making of stone tools is considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' because animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. This cognitive ability to create and use tools distinguished early humans from animals. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
37	Case Study: Atmospheric Pressure, Wind, and Local Breezes Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface. It is highest at sea level and decreases with altitude. Horizontally, air pressure distribution is influenced by temperature. In high-temperature areas, air heats up and rises, creating low-pressure areas associated with cloudy skies and wet weather. In lower-temperature areas, cold air sinks, creating high-pressure areas associated with clear and sunny skies. Air always moves from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, and this movement is called wind. Local winds like the sea breeze and land breeze affect coastal climates. During the day, land warms faster than sea, creating a low-pressure region over land, causing wind to blow from sea to land. At night, land cools faster than sea, and wind blows from land to sea. (i) What is atmospheric pressure and how does it change with altitude? (ii) How does temperature influence the creation of high-pressure and low-pressure areas? (iii) Explain the mechanism of sea breeze and land breeze, and how they create moderate climatic conditions in coastal regions. (iv) Why is a low-pressure area associated with cloudy skies and wet weather while a high-pressure area is associated with clear and sunny skies?	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: (i) Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface. It is highest at sea level and decreases rapidly as we go higher in the atmosphere. (ii) In areas with high temperatures, air heats up and rises, creating a low-pressure area. In areas with lower temperatures, air is cold and heavy, so it sinks, creating a high-pressure area. (iii) A sea breeze is a local wind that blows from sea to land during the day, especially in the afternoon, when land becomes relatively warmer than the sea, creating a low-pressure region over land. A land breeze blows from land to sea during the night, as land cools faster than sea, resulting in differential surface cooling. Since the difference in temperatures and air pressure between sea and land is low at night, the wind speed is low. These local winds are essential in creating moderate climatic conditions in coastal regions. (iv) In low-pressure areas, warm air heats up and rises, which leads to cloud formation and wet weather. In high-pressure areas, cold air is heavy and sinks, which prevents cloud formation, resulting in clear and sunny skies. ► Why? i) Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface. It is highest at sea level and decreases rapidly as we go higher in the atmosphere. ii) In areas with high temperatures, air heats up and rises, creating a low-pressure area. In areas with lower temperatures, air is cold and heavy, so it sinks, creating a high-pressure area. iii) A sea breeze is a local wind that blows from sea to land during the day, especially in the afternoon, when land becomes relatively warmer than the sea, creating a low-pressure region over land. A land breeze blows from land to sea during the night, as land cools faster than sea, resulting in differential surface cooling. Since the difference in temperatures and air pressure between sea and land is low at night, the wind speed is low. These local winds are essential in creating moderate climatic conditions in coastal regions. iv) In low-pressure areas, warm air heats up and rises, which leads to cloud formation and wet weather. In high-pressure areas, cold air is heavy and sinks, which prevents cloud formation, resulting in clear and sunny skies. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	

